PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	A systematic review protocol examining endothelial function and carotid artery disease in patients with inflammatory bowel disease
AUTHORS	Wu, Hao; Hu, Tingzi; Xu, Meihua; Hao, Hong; Hill, Michael; Xu, Canxia; Liu, Zhenguo

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Barreto, Joaquim Universidade Estadual de Campinas, Cardiology
REVIEW RETURNED	14-Dec-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This is a protocol manuscript for a systematic review of endothelial function and carotid artery disease in patients with inflammatory bowel disease. The rationale is adequately presented. The authors presented their methodology with clarity, in an objetive, clear manner., Henceforth, I believe it should proceed to publ

REVIEWER	Zhou, Jiliang Medical College of Georgia
REVIEW RETURNED	13-Mar-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	This study described a detailed protocol to be used by the investigators to conduct a thorough literature review and analysis on patients with inflammatory bowel disease (IBD). It is important to establish the relationship between IBD and the risk for the development of cardiovascular disease (CVD) since the data in the literature have been inconsistent. A detailed protocol is needed to provide a standard in the field to review and analyze the published data that determine whether patients with IBD have an increased CVD risk. The investigators followed the standard PRISMA guidelines with clearly defined criteria for study quality, endpoints, outcomes, and sample heterogeneity. The investigators plan to do a meta-analysis to summarize the findings after a systematic review and analysis on all published observational studies with IBD patients. Subgroup analyses is also proposed to determine if there is a sex difference. The strengths and limitations of the study have been clearly stated in the protocol. Overall, this is a well written protocol with logical design and is expected to offer important information in the field of IBD and CVDs. Minor issues: 1. Please state if there is an age limits on the selections of studies in the protocol.

	2. Please specify how to define “disease activity”, by clinical symptoms or biomarkers?

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1
Comments to the Author:
This is a protocol manuscript for a systematic review of endothelial function and carotid artery disease in patients with inflammatory bowel disease. The rationale is adequately presented. The authors presented their methodology with clarity, in an objective, clear manner., Henceforth, I believe it should proceed to publication.

Response: Thanks for your comments.

Reviewer: 2
Comments to the Author:

1. Please state if there is an age limits on the selections of studies in the protocol.

Response 1: Thanks for your comments. We will include all the pediatric and adult studies, and then age subgroup analyses will be conducted.

1. Please specify how to define “disease activity”, by clinical symptoms or biomarkers?

Response 2: Thanks for your comments. There are several clinical scoring systems to evaluate the disease activity of inflammatory bowel disease, such as Mayo score, Crohn’s disease activity index, and Truelove and Witts severity index. The active or inactive status will be addressed in the section of “descriptive analysis” in systematic review and meta-analysis.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Zhou, Jiliang Medical College of Georgia
REVIEW RETURNED	24-May-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	This reviewer has no further questions.